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JUN 17 2026

HUMBOLDT COUNTY
ELECTIONS

RESOLUTION NO. 26-07

RESOLUTION OF THE BOARD OF TRUSTEES OF THE FERNDALE UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT ORDERING AN ELECTION TO AUTHORIZE THE ISSUANCE OF GENERAL OBLIGATION BONDS FOR CAREER TECHNICAL EDUCATION PROJECTS, ESTABLISHING SPECIFICATIONS OF THE ELECTION ORDER, AND REQUESTING CONSOLIDATION WITH OTHER ELECTIONS OCCURRING ON NOVEMBER 3, 2026

WHEREAS, the Ferndale Unified School District (the "District") in Humboldt County (the "County"), State of California (the "State"), is committed to providing quality education to its students; and

WHEREAS, the District provides education to students in transitional kindergarten through grade twelve, and is committed to providing its students with Career Technical Education ("CTE") programs, pathways and educational facilities to provide a foundation for success in future careers and college education; and

WHEREAS, the District has identified important CTE facilities improvement needs including construction and modernization which must be addressed; and

WHEREAS, furthermore, the District desires to pursue or has pursued funding from the State under its CTE grant program and desires to provide a local match in order to realize said grants; and

WHEREAS, the Board of Trustees of the District (the "Board") has determined that it is necessary to address the foregoing concerns, among others; and

WHEREAS, on November 7, 2000, the voters of the State of California approved Proposition 39 ("Proposition 39"), which amended Articles XIIIA of the California Constitution ("Article XIIIA") to allow for the levy of *ad valorem* property taxes for the payment of bonded indebtedness of a school district, community college district or county office of education approved by at least 55 percent of the voters voting on such proposition; and

WHEREAS, upon the passage of Proposition 39, the Strict Accountability in Local School Construction Bond Act of 2000, being California Education Code Section 15264 and following (the "Act"), became operative; and

WHEREAS, in order to address the facilities needs of the District with respect to CTE projects as described herein, in the judgment of the Board, it is advisable to call an election pursuant to the Act to submit to the electors of the District the question whether bonds of the District shall be issued and sold pursuant to the authority of Article XVI Section 18 of the California Constitution and Article XIIIA (together with the Act, the "Law") for the purposes authorized by the Law and as described in Appendix A hereto (the "Full Text of Bond Measure"); and

WHEREAS, under the Act, the election may be ordered at a primary or general election, a regularly scheduled local election at which all of the electors of the District are entitled to vote, or a statewide special election, upon a two-thirds vote of the Board; and

WHEREAS, the Board desires to call an election in the District pursuant to the Law on November 3, 2026, which is the date of the statewide general election, and pursuant to Education Code Section 15121 and Elections Code Section 10400 and following, to request consolidation with any and all other elections held in the District on such date, and to request the Humboldt County Registrar of Voters (the "County Registrar") to perform election services for the District; and

WHEREAS, in connection with the calling of a bond election and in accordance with Education Code Section 15100 subparagraph (c), the Board has obtained reasonable and informed projections of assessed property valuations that take into consideration projections of assessed property valuations made by the County assessor, if any; and

WHEREAS, pursuant to United States Income Tax Regulations Section 1.150-2, the Board desires to declare its official intention at this time that if the measure submitted to voters hereunder is successful and bonds are issued pursuant to such measure, that it intends to reimburse from said bond proceeds any expenditures made by the District prior to the date of issuance of said bonds for the purposes described in the measure; and

NOW, THEREFORE, THE BOARD OF TRUSTEES OF THE FERNDALE UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT DOES HEREBY RESOLVE, DETERMINE AND ORDER AS FOLLOWS:

Section 1. Recitals; Findings. The foregoing recitals are true and correct.

Section 2. Call for Election. The Board hereby orders an election and submits to the electors of the District the question of whether general obligation bonds of the District shall be issued and sold in the maximum principal amount of $7,000,000 for the purposes described in the ballot measure approved under Section 4 and attached hereto as Appendix A (Full Text of Bond Measure) and Appendix B (Abbreviated Text of Bond Measure), and paying all costs incident thereto. This Resolution constitutes the order of the District to call such election and shall constitute the "specifications of the election order" pursuant to Education Code Section 5322.

Section 3. Election Date. The date of the election shall be November 3, 2026, and such bond election shall be held solely within the boundaries of the District. The boundaries of the District have not changed since the District's last election.

Section 4. Purpose of Election; Ballot Measure. The purpose of the election shall be for the voters in the District to vote on a bond measure, a full copy of which is attached hereto as Appendix A and marked "Appendix A – Full Text of Bond Measure" (the "Full Text of the Measure"), authorizing the District to issue general obligation bonds for the purposes stated therein, together with the accountability requirements of Article XIIIA and the requirements of Section 15272 of the Act. The Full Text of the Measure, which commences with the heading "FULL TEXT OF BOND MEASURE" and includes all of the text thereafter in Appendix A, shall be printed in the voter information pamphlet

provided to voters, with such measure designation as is assigned to the measure by the County elections official.

As required by Education Code Sections 5322 and 15122, Elections Code Section 13247, and in accordance with Elections Code Section 13119, the abbreviated statement of the measure to appear on the ballot is attached hereto as Appendix B and is marked as "Appendix B – Abbreviated Form of Bond Measure."

The President of the Board and the Superintendent are hereby separately authorized and directed to make any changes to the text of the bond measure as described herein to conform to any requirements of the Law or the County Registrar, to changes in applicable legal provisions, to address word count limitations, and upon the advice of its legal counsel. Any such changes shall be directed in writing by the Superintendent to the County Registrar.

Section 5. Authority for Election. The authority for ordering the election is contained in Section 15264 *et. seq.* of the Education Code, Article XVI Section 18(b) of the California Constitution and paragraph (b) subsection (3) of Article XIIIA. The authority for the specification of this election order is contained in Section 5322 of the Education Code.

Section 6. Proceeds for School Facilities Projects. The Board certifies that the proceeds from the sale of the bonds will be used only for the purposes specified in Article XIII A, Section 1(b)(3) as further specified in Appendix A, and not for any other purpose, including teacher and administrator salaries and other school operating expenses. Further, as required by Article XIIIA, the Board hereby certifies that it has evaluated safety, class size and information technology needs in developing the list of school facilities projects set forth in Appendix A.

Section 7. Covenants of the Board upon Approval of the Bonds by the Electorate; Accountability Measures. As required by Article XIIIA, Section 15278 of the Act, and Government Code Section 53410, in the event 55 percent of the voters voting in the District approve of the Bonds, the Board shall:

(a) conduct an annual, independent performance audit to ensure that the funds have been expended only on the projects listed in Appendix A;

(b) conduct an annual, independent financial audit of the proceeds from the sale of the Bonds until all of those proceeds have been expended for the school facilities projects listed in Appendix A;

(c) establish and appoint members to an independent citizens' oversight committee in accordance with Sections 15278, 15280, and 15282 of the Act;

(d) apply the Bond proceeds only to the specific purposes stated in the ballot proposition;

(e) cause the creation of accounts into which bond proceeds shall be deposited; and

(f) cause the preparation of an annual report pursuant to Government Code Sections 53410 and 53411.

Section 8. State Matching Funds. The Board hereby finds that some of the projects identified in the Full Text of Measure may require additional funding such as State matching funds, if available to the District, for completion. As such, the statement required by Education Code Section 15122.5 has been included in the Full Text of Measure attached hereto which shall be reproduced in the sample ballot. In addition, the District intends that the proceeds of bonds, if approved, will provide a source of funding for CTE projects which also qualify for a State grant, providing a local and encumbered source of funds only for CTE projects described on the Bond Project List.

Section 9. Delivery of this Resolution. The Clerk of the Board is hereby directed to send a copy of this Resolution, which shall include all appendices hereto, to (1) the County Registrar, and (2) the Humboldt County Clerk of the Board of Supervisors (the "Clerk of the Board") for purposes of consolidation pursuant to Elections Code Section 10403. The Resolution shall be received by the County Registrar and the Clerk of the Board no later than 88 days prior to the election date, unless otherwise permitted by law.

The County Registrar is hereby requested to print the full text of the ballot measure in the ballot materials as it appears on Appendix A hereto and to provide all required notices of the election and other notices related thereto. With respect to the Tax Rate Statement attached as Appendix C, in accordance with Elections Code Section 9405, the Board of Trustees adopts the procedures identified in said Section, and said Statement shall also be printed in the ballot materials.

Section 10. Consolidation of Election; Request to Provide Services. The County Registrar and the Humboldt County Board of Supervisors are hereby requested to consolidate the election ordered hereby with any and all other elections to be held on November 3, 2026 within the District.

Pursuant to Section 5303 of the Education Code and Section 10002 of the Elections Code, the Board of Supervisors of Humboldt County is requested to permit the County Registrar to render all services specified by Section 10418 of the Elections Code or other provision of law relating to the election, for which services the District agrees to reimburse Humboldt County in full upon presentation of an invoice from the County, such services to include the publication of a formal Notice of School Bond Election and the mailing of the sample ballot and tax rate statement (described in Section 9401 of the Elections Code).

Section 11. Approval of Tax Rate Statement. Pursuant to Elections Code Section 9400 and following, a tax rate statement has been prepared in the form attached hereto as Appendix C, which form of Tax Rate Statement is hereby approved for inclusion in the sample ballot. The President of the Board, the Superintendent, or any written designee of the foregoing, are hereby separately authorized and directed to execute the tax rate statement, and to file said Statement with the County Registrar, in accordance with Section 9 hereof.

Section 12. Ballot Arguments. As provided in Elections Code Section 9501, the District Board or any member or members of the District Board, are hereby authorized to (but not directed to) act as an author and signatory of any ballot argument prepared in connection with the election, including a rebuttal argument, each of which if filed shall be filed within the time frame established by the County Registrar.

Section 13. Maturity Limit of Bonds. The Bonds may be issued in one or more series by the District from time to time, and each series of Bonds shall mature not more than the legal limit at the time of such issuance thereof. The Bonds shall be issued under the Act, under the provisions of Section 53506 *et seq.* of the California Government Code, or under any other provision of law authorizing the issuance of general obligation bonds by school districts.

Section 14. Estimates Included in Ballot Materials. The measure authorized by this Resolution includes information presented to voters with respect to the estimated amount of money required to repay issued bonds, the estimated rate of the approved tax per $100,000 of assessed valuation (*ad valorem* tax), and the estimated duration through which the proposed tax supporting bond repayment will be levied and collected, among others. Any such estimates have been provided by the District in good faith based upon information currently available to the District, but depend on numerous variables which are subject to variation and change over the term of the District's overall facilities and bond financing plan. Such estimates and approximations are not intended by the Board, and shall not be interpreted or construed as additional restrictions on the District's bond program, bond issuances and related tax rate, and, other than the total principal amount of bonds authorized to be issued by the bond measure, do not represent legal maximums or additional limitations beyond applicable legal requirements. Furthermore, the abbreviated and condensed statement of the bond measure set forth in Appendix B, limited by State law to 75 words or less, does not limit the scope and more complete meaning provided in the Full Text of Bond Measure, set forth in Appendix A.

Section 15. Reimbursement. Pursuant to United States Income Tax Regulations Section 1.150-2, the District hereby declares that it may (i) pay certain costs of the projects listed in Appendix A prior to the date of issuance of bonds and, in such case, (ii) intends to use a portion of the proceeds of bonds for reimbursement of said expenditures for the projects that are paid before the date of issuance of bonds.

Section 16. Professional Services. The District reaffirms the engagement of Jones Hall LLP, as its Bond Counsel and Disclosure Counsel, and Isom Advisors, A Division of Urban Futures Inc., as its Municipal Advisor. The service agreements or amendments thereto on file with the Superintendent are hereby approved and the Superintendent is directed to execute said agreements on behalf of the District.

Section 17. Official Actions. The President of the Board and the Superintendent are hereby separately authorized and directed to execute and deliver to County officials any directions, requisitions or other writings, and to make and direct any changes to the texts of the measure as described herein and in the tax rate statement, to conform to any legal requirements of the County Registrar, in order to cause the election to be held and conducted in the District, and to designate the bond projects as intended to provide a match for State funds, in accordance with all legal requirements.

Section 18. Effective Date. This resolution shall take effect on and after its adoption.

* * * * * * * *

The foregoing Resolution was adopted by the Board of Trustees of the Ferndale Unified School District of Humboldt County, being the Board authorized by law to make the designations therein contained by the following vote, on June 9, 2026.

Adopted by the following votes: *[2/3 vote of Board required for approval]*

AYES: 4

NOES: Ø

ABSENT: 1

ABSTAIN:

President of the Board

Attest:

Julie Hagemann
Clerk/Secretary of the Board

APPENDIX A

FULL TEXT OF BOND MEASURE

The full text to be printed in the election material begins below the following line. The County Registrar is requested to input the assigned letter of this measure in the blank fields below.

FERNDALE UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT MEASURE ____
FULL TEXT OF MEASURE

BOND AUTHORIZATION

By approval of this measure by at least 55 percent of the registered voters voting on the measure, the Ferndale Unified School District (the "District") will be authorized to issue and sell general obligation bonds in the aggregate principal amount of up to $7,000,000 at interest rates not to exceed legal limits to provide financing for the specific types of school facilities projects listed under the heading "Bond Project List" below, subject to the accountability requirements specified below.

ACCOUNTABILITY REQUIREMENTS

The accountability requirements described below apply if this measure is approved.

Independent Citizens' Oversight Committee. The School Board will establish an Independent Citizens' Oversight Committee, under Education Code Sections 15278 and following, to ensure bond proceeds are expended only on the specific types of school facilities projects listed below. No employee or official of the District and no vendor, contractor or consultant of the District shall be appointed to the Oversight Committee.

Performance Audits. The School Board will conduct annual, independent performance audits to ensure that the bond proceeds have been expended only on the school facilities projects listed below.

Financial Audits. The School Board will conduct annual, independent financial audits of the bond proceeds until all of those proceeds have been spent for the school facilities projects listed below.

Government Code Accountability Requirements. As required by Section 53410 of the Government Code, (1) the specific purpose of the bonds is set forth in this Full Text of the Measure, (2) the proceeds from the sale of the bonds will be used only for the purposes specified in this measure, and not for any other purpose, (3) the proceeds of the bonds, when and if issued, will be deposited into a building fund to be held by the Humboldt County Treasurer, as required by the California Education Code, and (4) the Superintendent of the District shall cause an annual report to be filed with the District Board, which report shall contain information regarding the amount of funds collected and expended, as well as the status of the projects listed in this measure, as required by Sections 53410 and 53411 of the Government Code.

NO TEACHER OR ADMINISTRATOR SALARIES OR OPERATING EXPENSES

Under State law, proceeds from the sale of bonds authorized by this measure shall be used only for the purposes specified in Article XIII A, Section 1(b)(3) being on the construction, modernization, reconstruction, rehabilitation, replacement, or otherwise improve school facilities of the District, including furnishing and equipping, and not for any other purpose, including not for teacher and administrator salaries and other school operating expenses.

BOND PROJECT LIST

Specific School Facility Project List. The items presented on the following list identify the specific school facility projects authorized to be financed with voter-approved bond proceeds.

Authorized projects are:

CAREER TECHNICAL EDUCATION (CTE) PROJECTS
Construct, modernize, renovate and expand school facilities which provide CTE programs in the District, including upgrade classrooms, labs and other CTE facilities, including improvements to and development of outdoor spaces, and other facilities related to and supporting current and future CTE programs, including all improvements to interiors and exteriors, roofing, doors, windows, casework, flooring, millwork, painting, and lighting.
Provide necessary modern technology at CTE and related sites including installing or upgrading infrastructure sufficient to support modern technology, and providing modern teaching and learning equipment such as whiteboards, computers and other devices, software and other technology equipment.
Ensure healthy and safe environments and structures at CTE sites and related sites to ensure meeting all required State and local health standards and regulations, including no toxic chemicals, hazardous materials or exposures, addressing discoveries such as water or termite damage, and improvements to provide good air quality.
Provide all necessary new or upgraded infrastructure to CTE sites including electricity, plumbing and water and including energy efficiency upgrades.
Ensure comfortable learning and working environments at CTE sites with new or upgraded heating and ventilation systems.
Address safety and security at CTE sites including security systems and point of entry controls, camera systems, fire alarms, fire sprinkler

systems, door hardware, alarm systems, communication systems, lighting systems.
Ensure barrier-free access and compliance with all requirements of the American With Disabilities Act (ADA) at CTE sites and locations and all other similar laws and regulations.
Ensure legally compliant, improved and modernized bathrooms and changing rooms related to or serving students and staff in CTE programs.
Improvements and construction of facilities serving or related to CTE programs such as kitchens, food prep, cafeterias, and multi-purpose rooms, meeting and gathering spaces, offices, and similar spaces.
Improvements to exteriors of CTE program facilities such as sidewalks, parking, landscaping, lighting, and all site work necessary for and related to CTE sites and facilities.
Projects may be undertaken at any District-owned sites, including future sites, that provide or will provide CTE programs or education, or support to CTE, and proceeds may be used for real property/building and land acquisition including parcels, rights of ways, easements, and similar interests in real property.

Voters are informed that the current intent of the District is that most of the proceeds of these bonds provide the local match for facilities grants received or to be received under the State of California's Career Technical Education (CTE) Facilities Program or related or successor CTE program. Bond proceeds can only be expended on the specific projects identified on the foregoing Bond Project List, regardless of whether the District is successful in obtaining a CTE facilities grant.

Projects Not in Order of Priority. The order in which the foregoing projects are listed does not suggest an order of priority. Project prioritization is vested in and will be determined by the District Board.

Furnishing and Equipping; Incidental Expenses. Bond projects include the costs of furnishing and equipping such facilities, and all costs which are incidental but directly related to the types of projects described above. Examples of incidental costs include, but are not limited to: costs of design, engineering, architect and other professional services, facilities assessments and updates to master plan documents, inspections, site preparation, utilities, landscaping, construction management and other planning and permitting, legal including litigation, accounting and similar costs; independent annual financial and performance audits; a customary construction contingency; demolition and disposal of existing structures; the costs of interim housing and storage during construction including relocation and construction costs incurred relating to interim facilities; rental or construction of storage facilities and other space on an interim basis for materials and other equipment and furnishings displaced during construction; costs of relocating facilities and equipment as needed in connection with the projects; interim classrooms and facilities for students, administrators, and school functions, including modular and parking facilities; federal and state-mandated safety upgrades; addressing

unforeseen conditions revealed by construction/modernization and other necessary improvements required to comply with existing building codes, including the Field Act; access requirements of the Americans with Disabilities Act; costs of the election; bond issuance and compliance costs; and project administration during the duration of such projects, as permitted by law.

Alterations to Scope; New Construction. The scope, nature and priority of any of the specific projects described above may be altered by the School Board. This may occur due to unforeseen conditions that may arise during the course of planning, design and construction, or due to other compelling factors which become apparent in the course of project planning and execution, such as changing cost considerations, safety considerations, programmatic considerations or other considerations that arise or become apparent over the several years of undertaking bond financed projects. In the event that a modernization or renovation project is determined by the Board to be more economical or otherwise in the best interests of the District to be undertaken as new construction, this bond measure authorizes land acquisition, relocation and construction at a new or alternative site, and/or demolition and reconstruction and/or repurposing on the original site, including an expanded site, and all costs relating thereto.

Other Funding Sources. The Bond Project List presents more projects than are expected can be addressed with proceeds of this bond measure. The School Board will determine project prioritization and there is no guarantee that all projects will be addressed. Additional funds for facilities projects are expected to be pursued from the State's facilities matching funds program, specifically the program for CTE facilities, if and to the extent available and qualifying, to provide additional funding to complete facilities projects.

State Matching Funds. The following statement is included in this measure pursuant to Education Code Section 15122.5: Approval of this measure does not guarantee that the proposed project or projects that are the subject of bonds under this measure will be funded beyond the local revenues generated by this measure. The District's projects described below may assume the receipt of additional funding in the form of matching state funds, which, if available, could be subject to appropriation by the Legislature, or approval of a statewide bond measure.

Evaluation of Needs. As required by State law, the School Board has certified that it evaluated safety, class size reduction, enrollment growth, and information technology needs in developing the Bond Project List shown above.

Unforeseen Circumstances. Many factors which the District cannot predict or control may impact its ability to address each of the projects, including but not limited to construction cost issues, supply chain issues which can cause project delays, labor shortages, and unknown environmental factors or site conditions, among others. The District is unable to anticipate all unforeseen circumstances which may limit or prevent some of the projects listed above from being undertaken or completed.

INFORMATION ABOUT ESTIMATES AND PROJECTIONS INCLUDED IN BALLOT

Voters are informed that all estimates or projections in this bond measure and related ballot materials, including relating to estimated rates of *ad valorem* property taxes, the duration of issued bonds and related levies and collections of *ad valorem* property taxes are provided as informational only. Such amounts are estimates and projections made

in good faith, and are not maximum amounts or limitations on the terms of the bonds, the tax rate or the duration of the levy supporting repayment of issued bonds. Estimates and projections depend on numerous variables and assumptions which are subject to variation and change over the term of the District's overall facilities and bond financing plan, including but not limited to the amount of bonds issued and outstanding at any one time, the interest rates applicable to issued bonds, market conditions at the time of sale of the bonds, when bonds mature, timing of project needs and changes in assessed valuations in the District. As such, while such estimates and projections are provided based on information currently available to the District and its current expectations, such estimates and approximations are not limitations and are not binding upon the District. In addition, the abbreviated and condensed statement of the bond measure presented to voters on the ballot label which is subject to a word count limitation imposed by State law does not limit the scope and broader and more complete meaning of the measure provided in this Full Text of Bond Measure and related ballot materials.

INTERPRETATION AND SEVERABILITY

The terms of this Bond Measure and the words used in the Bond Project List shall be interpreted broadly to effect the purpose of providing broad and clear authority for the officers and employees of the District to provide for the school facilities projects the District proposes to finance with the proceeds of the sale of bonds authorized by this proposition within the authority provided by law, including Article XIIIA, Section 1(b)(3) of the California Constitution, Education Code Section 15000 *et seq.* and the Strict Accountability in Local School Construction Bonds Act of 2000. Examples included on the project list are not intended to limit the broader types of projects described and authorized by this measure. Words used in the Project List such as repair, improve, upgrade, expand, modernize, renovate, and reconfigure are used to describe school facilities projects in plain English but are not intended to expand the nature of such projects beyond what is authorized by State law. The Bond Project List only authorizes capital expenditures.

The District Board hereby declares, and the voters by approving this Bond Measure concur, that every section and part of this bond proposition has independent value, and the District Board and the voters would have adopted each provision hereof regardless of every other provision hereof. Upon approval of this measure by the voters, should any part be found by a court of competent jurisdiction to be invalid for any reason, all remaining parts hereof shall remain in full force and effect to the fullest extent allowed by law, and to this end the provisions of this bond measure are severable.

The Full Text of Measure ends above the line.

APPENDIX B

ABBREVIATED FORM OF BOND MEASURE

To prepare students for careers and college and qualify for state matching grants by: constructing/ modernizing Career Technology Education classrooms, labs and related facilities; and making related improvements for health, safety and security; shall Ferndale Unified School District's measure be adopted authorizing $7,000,000 of bonds at legal rates, generating on average $483,000 annually while bonds are outstanding at approximate rates of $49.70 per $100,000 assessed value, with annual audits, oversight, no money for salaries, all money staying local?

Bonds—Yes Bonds—No

APPENDIX C

TAX RATE STATEMENT
REGARDING PROPOSED
FERNDALE UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT
GENERAL OBLIGATION BONDS

An election will be held in the Ferndale Unified School District (the "District") on November 3, 2026, to authorize the sale of up to $7,000,000 in bonds of the District to finance school facilities as described in the measure. If such bonds are authorized and sold, principal and interest on the bonds will be payable only from the proceeds of *ad valorem* tax levies made upon the taxable property in the District. The following information is provided in compliance with Sections 9400-9404 of the Elections Code of the State of California. Such information is based upon the best estimates and projections presently available from official sources, upon experience within the District, and other demonstrable factors.

Based upon the foregoing and projections of the District's assessed valuation, the following information is provided:

1. The best estimate of the average annual tax rate which would be required to be levied to fund this bond issue over the entire duration of the bond debt service, based on a projection of assessed valuations available at the time of filing of this statement, is $49.70 per $100,000 of assessed value. The final fiscal year in which the tax is anticipated to be collected is 2058-59.

2. The best estimate of the highest tax rate which would be required to be levied to fund this bond issue, based on a projection of assessed valuations available at the time of filing of this statement, is $49.95 per $100,000 of assessed value. It is estimated that such rate would be levied in fiscal year 2028-29.

3. The best estimate of the total debt service, including the principal and interest, that would be required to be repaid if all the bonds are issued and sold is approximately $15,444,000.

Voters should note the estimated tax rate is based on the assessed value (not market value) of taxable property on the Humboldt County's official tax rolls. In addition, taxpayers eligible for a property tax exemption such as the homeowner's exemption will have a lower effective tax rate than described above. Property owners should consult their own property tax bills and tax advisors to determine their property's assessed value and any applicable tax exemptions.

The attention of all voters is directed to the fact that the foregoing information is based upon projections and estimates only, which amounts are not maximum amounts and are not binding upon the District. The actual debt service, tax rates and the years in which they will apply may vary from those performed as of a certain date in time and used to provide the estimates set forth above, due to factors such as variations in the timing of bond sales, the par amount of bonds sold and market interest rates available at the time

of each sale, actual assessed valuations over the term of the bonds, and other factors. The date and amount of bonds sold at any given time will be determined by the District based on the need for project funds and other considerations. The actual interest rates at which the bonds will be sold will depend on conditions in the bond market at the time of sale. Actual future assessed valuations will depend upon the amount and value of taxable property within the District as determined by the Humboldt County Assessor in the annual assessment and the equalization process.

Superintendent
Ferndale Unified School District

MEASURE E– IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS

HUMBOLDT COUNTY COUNSEL

FERNDALE UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

SCHOOL FACILITIES BOND MEASURE

Measure E is a bond measure placed on the ballot by the Ferndale Unified School District, which would allow the district to issue bonds in the amount of up to $7 million to pay for specific school facilities projects. Measure E must be approved by a 55 percent vote.

The California Constitution authorizes a school district to issue bonds for "the construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation, or replacement of school facilities, including the furnishing and equipping of school facilities, or the acquisition or lease of real property for school facilities." The use of the funds is restricted to these uses, and "not for any other purpose, including teacher and administrator salaries and other school operating expenses." The measure must include "a list of specific school facilities projects to be funded by the bond." Measure E complies with this requirement, listing projects related to creating and upgrading facilities for career technical education.

By law, the district must "conduct an annual, independent performance audit to ensure that the funds have been expended only on the specific projects listed." This audit is then provided to a citizen's oversight committee, whose purpose is to inform and advise the public on the expenditure of bond funds. Measure E complies with these requirements as well.

California's Proposition 13 generally prohibits the imposition of an ad valorem property tax exceeding one percent. (An ad valorem tax is a tax on real property as a percentage of the cash value of the property.) However, there is an exception that allows a school district to levy an ad valorem tax which exceeds this one percent for the limited purpose of construction related to school facilities. The maximum tax allowed by law for a unified school district is $60 per $100,000 of assessed property value. As stated in the ballot question and the tax rate statement included with the ballot materials, the district estimates that the average tax levy necessary to pay for the debt obligation would be $49.70 per $100,000 of assessed property value.

The bonds would allow the district to raise $7 million. The district estimates that total debt service, including principal and interest, required to be paid if all bonds are issued and sold, would be $15.4 million.

Argument in Favor of Measure E

Ferndale Unified School District

Our schools are amongst this community's most important assets, and our Career Technical Education and Agricultural programs are a large part of that. With high-quality schools and programs come improved student achievement, better preparation for their futures, informative decision-making skills and strengthened neighborhood safety, all of which raise our community and property values. Ferndale's teachers and staff do excellent work, but many facilities in the Ferndale Unified School District utilize outdated equipment, classrooms and labs that are no longer able to meet students' needs.

Measure E allows Ferndale to secure millions in state funding for CTE programs. The District already received a $3 million State CTE grant for a new Agriculture Education building, and voter approval of Measure E could unlock another $3 million grant to replace the aging shop building. Without Measure E, Ferndale would not have the required local matching dollars to receive these and other grants, sending millions in education dollars to another community.

Measure E prepares Ferndale students for careers and college by:

- Constructing and modernizing CTE classrooms, labs, and related facilities, including a new Agriculture Education building
- Making health, safety, security, and ADA improvements for CTE facilities and programs
- Upgrading CTE-related kitchens, training facilities, and outdoor spaces

Measure E makes financial sense and protects taxpayers by:

- Requiring annual audits by an independent citizens' oversight committee
- Funds can only be spent on CTE-related facilities, not administrator or teacher salaries
- All bond funds must be spent locally and cannot be taken by the State

Ferndale Elementary is a Distinguished School, and Ferndale High has an award-winning FFA program. Measure E builds on this success by providing facilities that match the quality of our CTE and Agriculture programs and give students hands-on, career-ready training for college and the workforce.

Don't let $6 million go to another community. **VOTE YES ON MEASURE E!**

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HUMBOLDT COUNTY ELECTIONS

BALLOT ARGUMENT STATEMENT FORM

Elections Code Section 9600

All arguments concerning measures filed pursuant to California Elections Code Division 9, commencing with Section 9000, shall be accompanied by the following form statement, to be signed by each proponent and by each author, if different, of the argument:

The undersigned proponent(s) or author(s) of the Primary (primary/rebuttal to)

argument in favor of (in favor of/against) ballot proposition Measure E (name or number)

at the November 2026 General Election (title of election)

for the Ferndale Unified School District (jurisdiction)

to be held on November 3, 2026 (date of election) hereby state that such

argument is true and correct to the best of their (his/her/their) knowledge and belief.

Signed [signature] Date 08-03-2026

Printed name William G Becker Title Retired Businessowner

Signed [signature] Date 8-4-26

Printed name Jim Walker Title Dairyman

Signed [signature] Date 8-05-2026

Printed name Alexa Alexandre Title Agriculture Teacher

Signed [signature] Date 8-07-2026

Printed name Luke McCuniggs Title Dairyman

Signed [signature] Date 8/7/2026

Printed name Brice Titus Title Business Owner

AUTHOR INFORMATION

Signed [signature] Date 8/7/2026

Printed name Danielle Carmesin Title Superintendent

Mailing Address 164 Shaw Ave, Ferndale CA 95536